

The Canon PIXMA MP150 is next at Rs 6,495. The black print quality is almost as good as that of the much higher-priced HP Officejet 5610 All-in-One. Even under the magnifying glass, we could not find any gaps in the print, which is a good thing—but it does show an occasional smudge. However, this is no cause for worry: the print looks good even under close inspection with the naked eye. Just 10 seconds for the first print is going to keep a lot of office people happy. For colour printing, however, the Normal mode robs images of their vivid colours. You can make out speckles that can even be counted individually at some points! This is obviously an effort to save on ink. If you need a better print, you'll have to set the quality to Best—the images suddenly get their life back, which will leave you pleasantly surprised.



Brother DCP-115 C

The Brother MFC-215C and the Lexmark P6250 are dearer than the Canon MP150 by about Rs 1,000 (at Rs 7,990 and Rs 7,999 respectively). Black printing is better with the P6250, but it is still not in the league of the HP 5610 or even the lower-priced Canon MP150. The Lexmark is one of the fastest printers with just 11 seconds taken at the Normal setting. The 215C, like its little brother the 115C, took a lazy 26 seconds. But when it came to colour printing, the Lexmark produced very visible bands, which did not go away even at the Best quality setting. The Brother 215C produced better colours, but with some specks visible in the Normal mode—an ink-saving compromise again. The Best mode got the prints to look much better, though the specks could not be entirely eliminated. Black and white copy quality

Canon PIXMA MP530

This is a heavy-duty MFD targeted at those who want it all. The print, scan, fax and copy functions are all supported.

The MP530 is capable of printing photos and has special features for this purpose: the PictBridge feature lets you connect a compliant digital camera or camcorder directly to the MFD. You can preview a photo in the 6.3 cm colour LCD screen before printing it. There are five separate ink cartridges to print photos in colours as close to those of the original image as possible. In addition to being capable of printing on a variety of media, there is also an attachment that allows you to print to CDs and DVDs.

A 33.6 kbps modem allows you to send faxes at 200 x 200 dpi. It can receive and store up to 150 pages of fax while you are away. Up to 40 numbers can be stored and recalled as required. The Activity Report feature logs all faxes sent and received from the MFD—a feature useful for system administrators.

The scanner is a 48-bit flatbed and does its job at 1200 x 2400 dpi, which is good enough for scanning fine details. The ADF can hold 30 pages. The copier can be set to make up to 99 copies of a document, either in colour or black.

Build quality is very good. The MP530 weighs 12.8 kg—a bit on the higher side for an inkjet MFD. Printing was quite fast—it printed the first page in just seven seconds, and it printed the test photo in an average time of 180 seconds. The scanner performance, however, wasn't spectacular, with average scan times, but the quality of the prints was quite good.

The Canon PIXMA MP530 is priced at Rs 20,995.

- + Fast Printing Speed**
- Slow Scanner Speed
Price: Rs. 20,995





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